SSC MTS 2021 Paper-I question paper with answers

14 July 2022 · Shift 3

69 questions as the Staff Selection Commission (SSC) printed them · answers from the official key · marking: +1 for a right answer, –0.25 for a wrong one

The other 31 of the paper's 100 questions are not reproduced: they need a figure or are printed as an image, or ask about formatting the source does not keep.

Try every question first: the answer key and the explanations follow the questions. Official answer-key notice: https://web.archive.org/web/20221017140324/https://ssc.nic.in/SSCFileServer/PortalManagement/UploadedFiles/Writeup_FinalAnswerKeyMTS2021_17102022.pdf

General English 25 questions

Q.1

Select the option that can be used as a one-word substitute for the given group of words. An imaginary name assumed by an author

(A) Nomenclature
(B) Almanac
(C) Pseudonym
(D) Platonic

Q.2

Select the most appropriate ANTONYM of the given word. Hideous

(A) Disgusting
(B) Shocking
(C) Attractive
(D) Ghastly

Q.3

The following sentence has been divided into parts. One of them may contain an error. Select the part that contains the error from the given options. If you don't find any error, mark 'No error' as your answer. If he had not dropped out, / he will most certainly have completed / his education by 2023.

(A) his education by 2023
(B) No error
(C) If he had not dropped out
(D) he will most certainly have completed

Q.4

Select the most appropriate meaning of the given idiom. In the heat of the moment

(A) Saying or doing something without thinking due to anger
(B) Keep something away from everyone
(C) To share information that was previously concealed
(D) In a confused or befuddled state of mind

Q.5

Select the sentence in which all words are correctly spelt.

(A) With him he had one of his cheif councellors.
(B) Work is due to comence in the coming year.
(C) Melt the white and dark chocolate in separate bowls.
(D) We did it becuase we felt it our duty to encorage him.

Q.6

Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank. We _____ learn to meet adversity gracefully.

(A) have
(B) ought
(C) had
(D) must

Q.7

Select the most appropriate meaning of the underlined idiom in the given sentence. I accidentally “let the cat out of the bag” about your promotion.

(A) To state the wrong facts
(B) To reveal a secret
(C) To say something unrealistic
(D) To discourage someone

Q.8

Select the option that will improve the underlined part of the given sentence. In case no improvement is needed, select 'No improvement required'. He went to bed early to “get up on time” to attend his morning lecture.

(A) get up over time
(B) No improvement required
(C) get up for time
(D) get up at time

Q.9

Select the option that will improve the underlined part of the sentence. In case no improvement is needed, select ‘No improvement required’. He sounded like he “were to going” cry.

(A) No improvement required
(B) were going to
(C) going to
(D) was going to

Q.10

Parts of the following sentence have been given as options. One of them may contain an error. Select the part that contains the error from the given options. If you don’t find any error, mark ‘No error’ as your answer. Educators must roll up their sleeves and do a more best job of teaching critical thinking.

(A) Educators must roll up their sleeves
(B) No error
(C) and do a more best job
(D) of teaching critical thinking

Q.11

Select the correctly spelt word.

(A) Rudimentry
(B) Concious
(C) Coalece
(D) Reliant

Q.12

Select the option that will improve the underlined part of the given sentence. In case no improvement is needed, select 'No improvement required'. Grammar is just a natural function of children's brains, “and they apply it to” whatever they find.

(A) No improvement required
(B) they applied them to
(C) they apply them for
(D) they apply that in

Q.13

Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank. Can you please _____ this sauce over the pasta?

(A) pore
(B) power
(C) pour
(D) purr

Q.14

Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank. We deplore the use of _____ against innocent people.

(A) reduction
(B) violence
(C) gentleness
(D) humour

Q.15

Select the most appropriate synonym of the given word. August

(A) Imminent
(B) Eminent
(C) Permanent
(D) Illicit

Q.16

The following sentence has been divided into parts. One of them may contain an error. Select the part that contains the error from the given options. If you don't find any error, mark 'No error' as your answer. The panel will / investigate the allegations / owing to the concerned officials.

(A) investigate the allegations
(B) owing to the concerned officials
(C) The panel will
(D) No error

Q.17

Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank. A _____ body will fight off the illness naturally without any medicine.

(A) happy
(B) healthy
(C) flabby
(D) fresh

Q.18

Select the most appropriate synonym of the given word. Mandate

(A) Question
(B) Request
(C) Enquire
(D) Command

Q.19

Select the most appropriate ANTONYM of the underlined word in the given sentence. I do not feel it is a "laudable" plan.

(A) noticeable
(B) precious
(C) commendable
(D) disrespected

Q.20

Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank. India continues to _____ the highest amount of e-waste, more than China, the US, Japan and Germany.

(A) generate
(B) remake
(C) stake
(D) select

Q.21

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. Words convey meaning, because they are used in human activities in different forms. Different words may (1) _____ the same thing in different languages and this is what is referred to as 'family resemblance.' In other words, languages help us (2) _____ reality and then communicate it to others. There are tens and thousands of languages in the world and all of them help us (3) _____ express ourselves, which in turn, gives meaning to our life. One's mother tongue is (4) _____ for one's literary growth, but if you want to communicate to a wider audience, then you will (5) _____ to reach out to the target audience in a language they understand.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 1.

(A) meaningful
(B) meaning
(C) mean
(D) meant

Q.22

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. Words convey meaning, because they are used in human activities in different forms. Different words may (1) _____ the same thing in different languages and this is what is referred to as 'family resemblance.' In other words, languages help us (2) _____ reality and then communicate it to others. There are tens and thousands of languages in the world and all of them help us (3) _____ express ourselves, which in turn, gives meaning to our life. One's mother tongue is (4) _____ for one's literary growth, but if you want to communicate to a wider audience, then you will (5) _____ to reach out to the target audience in a language they understand.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 2.

(A) commend
(B) depend
(C) comprehend
(D) amend

Q.23

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. Words convey meaning, because they are used in human activities in different forms. Different words may (1) _____ the same thing in different languages and this is what is referred to as 'family resemblance.' In other words, languages help us (2) _____ reality and then communicate it to others. There are tens and thousands of languages in the world and all of them help us (3) _____ express ourselves, which in turn, gives meaning to our life. One's mother tongue is (4) _____ for one's literary growth, but if you want to communicate to a wider audience, then you will (5) _____ to reach out to the target audience in a language they understand.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 3.

(A) retrospectively
(B) secretly
(C) effectively
(D) lately

Q.24

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. Words convey meaning, because they are used in human activities in different forms. Different words may (1) _____ the same thing in different languages and this is what is referred to as 'family resemblance.' In other words, languages help us (2) _____ reality and then communicate it to others. There are tens and thousands of languages in the world and all of them help us (3) _____ express ourselves, which in turn, gives meaning to our life. One's mother tongue is (4) _____ for one's literary growth, but if you want to communicate to a wider audience, then you will (5) _____ to reach out to the target audience in a language they understand.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 4.

(A) essential
(B) unimportant
(C) auspicious
(D) silent

Q.25

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. Words convey meaning, because they are used in human activities in different forms. Different words may (1) _____ the same thing in different languages and this is what is referred to as 'family resemblance.' In other words, languages help us (2) _____ reality and then communicate it to others. There are tens and thousands of languages in the world and all of them help us (3) _____ express ourselves, which in turn, gives meaning to our life. One's mother tongue is (4) _____ for one's literary growth, but if you want to communicate to a wider audience, then you will (5) _____ to reach out to the target audience in a language they understand.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 5.

(A) have
(B) should
(C) has
(D) had

General Intelligence and Reasoning 19 questions

Q.1

Select the option that is related to the third letter-cluster in the same way as the second letter-cluster is related to the first letter-cluster. GRV : IUE :: XCB : ?

(A) ZFY
(B) YFX
(C) ZEY
(D) YEX

Q.2

Select the option that is related to the fifth number in the same way as the second number is related to the first number and the fourth number is related to the third number. 339 : 1022 :: 58 : 179 :: 25 : ?

(A) 80
(B) 70
(C) 75
(D) 125

Q.4

Select the option in which the two numbers are related in the same way as are the numbers in the given number pairs. 23 : 529; 26 : 676

(A) 24 : 576
(B) 16 : 196
(C) 18 : 400
(D) 22 : 444

Q.5

Select the option that is related to the third letter-cluster in the same way as the second letter-cluster is related to the first letter-cluster. GRM : MGR :: PAR : ?

(A) RPA
(B) PRA
(C) ARP
(D) RAP

Q.7

In a certain code language, 'HOPE' is written as 'KRSH', and 'RAGF' is written as 'UDJI'. How will 'MNCK' be written in that language?

(A) PQEM
(B) PQFN
(C) PQEN
(D) PQFM

Q.8

Which two numbers (NOT digits) and two signs need to be interchanged to make the given equation correct?
35 ÷ 4 × 48 + 70 – 10 = 40

(A) 35 and 48, – and ÷
(B) 70 and 10, + and –
(C) 4 and 48, × and +
(D) 70 and 48, ÷ and ×

Q.9

Which two numbers should be interchanged to make the given equation correct? 9 + 6 ÷ 4 – 5 + 3 = 10

(A) 6 and 10
(B) 10 and 5
(C) 9 and 3
(D) 4 and 3

Q.10

Select the option that is related to the fifth number in the same way as the second number is related to the first number and the fourth number is related to the third number. 29 : 31 :: 19 : 23 :: 31 : ?

(A) 37
(B) 43
(C) 47
(D) 41

Q.12

In a certain code language, 'PAINTS' is written as 'HGMRZK' and 'ROCKY' is written as 'BPXLI'. How will 'HUNTER' be written in that language?

(A) IUGMSF
(B) IVGMFS
(C) IVGMES
(D) IUGMFS

Q.13

Seven students Pawan, Aman, Raman, Sanam, Tanmay, Umang and Vikram took a series of tests. No two students got similar marks. Vikram scored just more than Pawan and Pawan scored just more than Aman. Raman and Tanmay scored the highest and the least marks but not necessarily in the same order. Umang's score was less than only Raman's score. Sanam's score was higher than only one person. Whose score was in between the scores of Pawan and Sanam?

(A) Vikram
(B) Umang
(C) Raman
(D) Aman

Q.14

Six boys G1, G2, G3, G4, G5 and G6 are sitting in a row facing towards the north (not necessarily in the same order). G4 is second to the right of G5. G2 is second to the left of G5. G3 is to the immediate left of G2. G6 is second to the right of G3. How many boys are sitting to the left of G6?

(A) 2
(B) 3
(C) 0
(D) 1

Q.15

Select the option that is related to the fifth alphanumeric-cluster in the same way as the second alphanumeric-cluster is related to the first alphanumeric-cluster and the fourth alphanumeric-cluster is related to the third alphanumeric-cluster. STV20 : WXZ24 :: ABD2 : EFH6 :: IJL10 : ?

(A) MNP14
(B) MNO14
(C) NOP15
(D) NOQ15

Q.16

Read the given statements and conclusions carefully. Assuming that the information given in the statements is true, even if it appears to be at variance with commonly known facts, decide which of the given conclusions logically follow(s) from the statements. Statements: I. Some red are mouse. II. No grey is mouse. Conclusions: I. All red are grey. II. No mouse is grey.

(A) Only conclusion I follows
(B) None of the conclusions follow
(C) Both conclusions I and II follow
(D) Only conclusion II follows

Q.17
Select the number from among the given options that can replace the question mark (?) in the following series.
48, 54, 45, 51, 42, 48, ?

(A) 37
(B) 33
(C) 39
(D) 35

Q.18
Read the given statements and conclusions carefully. Assuming that the information given in the statements is true, even if it appears to be at variance with commonly known facts, decide which of the given conclusions logically follow(s) from the statements. Statements: I. Some cars are white. II. Some locks are white. Conclusions: I. All white are locks. II. No car is a lock. III. All locks are cars.

(A) All the conclusions follow
(B) Only conclusion III follows
(C) Only conclusion II follows
(D) None of the conclusions follow

Q.19
Select the letter-cluster from among the given options that can replace the question mark (?) in the following series. TRO, RQM, PPK, NOI, ?

(A) LNH
(B) LMG
(C) LMH
(D) LNG

Q.22
Six people Akshay, Anurag, Amit, Anubhav, Aryan and Ashish are sitting in a straight row facing North. Neither Akshay nor Amit are sitting at the corners. Amit and Anubhav are immediate neighbour of each other. Aryan is sitting second from the right corner. Only Akshay is sitting in between Anubhav and Ashish. Amit is sitting second to the left of Anurag. Who is sitting in between Anurag and Amit?

(A) Ashish
(B) Anubhav
(C) Akshay
(D) Aryan

Q.23
In a certain code language, 'BAG' is coded as '71', and 'VICE' is coded as '69'. How will 'LIKE' be coded in that code language?

(A) 71
(B) 76
(C) 68
(D) 65

Q.24
In a certain code language, if 'owl' is known as 'peacock', 'peacock' is known as 'cuckoo', 'cuckoo' is known as 'pigeon', and 'pigeon' is known as 'sparrow', then what would be the name of the bird that sings well?

(A) Pigeon
(B) peacock
(C) sparrow
(D) Cuckoo

General Awareness 25 questions

Q.1
Sangrai is a folk dance of which state of India?

(A) Bihar
(B) Tripura
(C) Karnataka
(D) Goa

Q.2
India’s southern neighbours across the sea consist of _____ island countries.

(A) three
(B) four
(C) five
(D) two

Q.3
Tipu Sultan became the ruler of Mysore in _____.

(A) 1765
(B) 1782
(C) 1775
(D) 1762

Q.4
'Courage and Conviction : An Autobiography' is the autobiography of which of the following persons?

(A) Yogesh Kumar Joshi
(B) Dalbir Singh Suhag
(C) Manoj Mukund Naravane
(D) VK Singh

Q.5
Which of the following festivals is associated with the Kamakhya temple of Guwahati?

(A) Ambubachi Festival
(B) Mando Festival
(C) Majuli Festival
(D) Sunburn festival

Q.6
Which of the following states has bi-cameral Legislature as of March 2022?

(A) Odisha
(B) Gujarat
(C) Karnataka
(D) Kerala

Q.7
Which of the following states launched the 'Mukhyamantri Ration Aapke Dwar Yojana' in October 2021?

(A) Punjab
(B) Uttarakhand
(C) Jharkhand
(D) Madhya Pradesh

Q.8
What is a measure of the moisture present in air called?

(A) Opacity
(B) Abrasion
(C) Precipitation
(D) Humidity

Q.9
Which Article of the Constitution of India under the Directive Principles of State Policy talks about organisation of village panchayats?

(A) Article 40
(B) Article 48
(C) Article 43
(D) Article 39A

Q.10
The first census of Independent India was conducted in _____.

(A) 1956
(B) 1953
(C) 1951
(D) 1948

Q.11
Articles _____ in Part VI of the Constitution deal with the components of state legislature.

(A) 168 to 212
(B) 198 to 220
(C) 112 to 175
(D) 134 to 198

Q.12
In which language did Banabhatta compose Harshacharita?

(A) Sanskrit
(B) Pali
(C) Tamil
(D) Prakrit

Q.13

Which of the following statements is correct? I. Converting plant and animal waste including that from kitchen into manure is called composting. II. The method of making compost from kitchen garbage using redworms is called vermicomposting.

(A) Only I is correct.
(B) Neither I nor II is correct.
(C) Both I and II are correct.
(D) Only II is correct.

Q.14

TH Vinayakram is associated with which musical instrument?

(A) Dholak
(B) Sarod
(C) Tabla
(D) Ghatam

Q.15

Which of the following is NOT a tributary of the Indus river?

(A) Son
(B) Kabul
(C) Gilgit
(D) Shyok

Q.16

_____ won the ICC Women's Cricket World Cup 2022.

(A) New Zealand
(B) Australia
(C) India
(D) England

Q.17

Who said, ‘One caste, one religion, one God for humankind’?

(A) Jyotirao Phule
(B) Mahatma Gandhi
(C) Shree Narayana Guru
(D) Dr. Rajendra Prasad

Q.18

The North-South corridor of the Golden Quadrilateral Super Highways links Srinagar and _____.

(A) Kanchipuram
(B) Kozhikode
(C) Kannur
(D) Kanyakumari

Q.19

Which of the following is the correct chronological order of early Turkish rulers who ruled over Delhi from the year 1206 to 1290?

(A) Qutubuddin Aybak, Shamsuddin Illtutmish, Raziyaa
(B) Raziyya, Shamsuddin Illtutmish, Qutubuddin Aybak
(C) Qutubuddin Aybak, Raziyya, Shamsuddin Illtutmish
(D) Shamsuddin Illutmish, Raziyya, Qutubuddin Aybak

Q.20

Which cell organelle performs the principal function of packaging materials?

(A) Endoplasmic reticulum
(B) Golgi apparatus
(C) Lysosome
(D) Vacuoles

Q.21

Pushkar lake is situated in which district of Rajasthan?

(A) Jaipur
(B) Ajmer
(C) Bikaner
(D) Alwar

Q.22

Who among the following won the first ever individual Olympic medal for India?

(A) Rajyavardhan Rathore
(B) PT Usha
(C) Khashaba Jadhav
(D) Abhinav Bindra

Q.23

In February 2022, beverage maker Coca-Cola signed _____ as the brand ambassador for Thums Up.

(A) Mahendra Singh Dhoni
(B) Ranveer Singh
(C) Akshay Kumar
(D) Shah Rukh Khan

Q.24

'Padma Vibhushan' winner Pandit Birju Maharaj was a famous _____ dancer.

(A) Odissi
(B) Kathak
(C) Bharatanatyam
(D) Manipuri

Q.25

What chemical element does 'H' stand for in the science periodic table?

(A) Helium
(B) Hydrogen
(C) Holmium
(D) Mercury

Answer key

General English

Q.1 **(C)**	Q.2 **(C)**	Q.3 **(D)**	Q.4 **(A)**	Q.5 **(C)**	Q.6 **(D)**
Q.7 **(B)**	Q.8 **(B)**	Q.9 **(D)**	Q.10 **(C)**	Q.11 **(D)**	Q.12 **(A)**
Q.13 **(C)**	Q.14 **(B)**	Q.15 **(B)**	Q.16 **(B)**	Q.17 **(B)**	Q.18 **(D)**
Q.19 **(D)**	Q.20 **(A)**	Q.21 **(C)**	Q.22 **(C)**	Q.23 **(C)**	Q.24 **(A)**
Q.25 **(A)**					

General Intelligence and Reasoning

Q.1 **(A)**	Q.2 **(A)**	Q.4 **(A)**	Q.5 **(A)**	Q.7 **(B)**	Q.8 **(D)**
Q.9 **(D)**	Q.10 **(A)**	Q.12 **(B)**	Q.13 **(D)**	Q.14 **(A)**	Q.15 **(A)**
Q.16 **(D)**	Q.17 **(C)**	Q.18 **(D)**	Q.19 **(D)**	Q.22 **(D)**	Q.23 **(A)**
Q.24 **(A)**					

General Awareness

Q.1 **(B)**	Q.2 **(D)**	Q.3 **(B)**	Q.4 **(D)**	Q.5 **(A)**	Q.6 **(C)**
Q.7 **(D)**	Q.8 **(D)**	Q.9 **(A)**	Q.10 **(C)**	Q.11 **(A)**	Q.12 **(A)**
Q.13 **(C)**	Q.14 **(D)**	Q.15 **(A)**	Q.16 **(B)**	Q.17 **(C)**	Q.18 **(D)**
Q.19 **(A)**	Q.20 **(B)**	Q.21 **(B)**	Q.22 **(C)**	Q.23 **(D)**	Q.24 **(B)**
Q.25 **(B)**					

Explanations

General English

Q.1 · Answer (C) Pseudonym

A pseudonym is a false name an author writes under. Nomenclature is a system of names, an almanac a yearly book of dates and facts, and 'platonic' an adjective.

Q.2 · Answer (C) Attractive

'Hideous' means very ugly; its opposite is 'attractive'. 'Disgusting', 'shocking' and 'ghastly' are close to it in sense.

Q.3 · Answer (D) he will most certainly have completed

A past unreal condition ('If he had not dropped out') takes 'would have' + past participle in the main clause: 'he would most certainly have completed'.

Q.4 · Answer (A) Saying or doing something without thinking due to anger

Something said or done 'in the heat of the moment' is done without thinking, while angry or excited.

Q.5 · Answer (C) Melt the white and dark chocolate in separate bowls.

Only the third sentence is spelt correctly. The others misspell 'chief', 'councillors' (or 'counsellors'), 'commence', 'because' and 'encourage'.

Q.6 · Answer (D) must

'Must' expresses necessity and takes the bare infinitive 'learn'. 'Ought', 'have' and 'had' would all need 'to' before 'learn'.

Q.7 · Answer (B) To reveal a secret

To 'let the cat out of the bag' is to reveal a secret, often by accident.

Q.8 · Answer (B) No improvement required

'On time' means at the right time, punctually, so the sentence needs no change. 'Over time' means gradually, and 'for time' and 'at time' are not idiomatic.

Q.9 · Answer (D) was going to

SSC's key gives 'was going to': the future seen from the past is 'was going to' + verb, and the indicative 'was' suits something he really seemed about to do ('He sounded like he was going to cry'). Formal English may use the subjunctive 'were' after 'as if' to mark a comparison as unreal, which nothing here suggests; 'going to' alone leaves out the verb 'be'.

Q.10 · Answer (C) and do a more best job

'More best' is a double comparison; the comparative of 'good' is 'better': 'do a better job'.

Q.11 · Answer (D) Reliant

'Reliant' is spelt correctly. The others should be 'rudimentary', 'conscious' and 'coalesce'.

Q.12 · Answer (A) No improvement required

'It' refers back to the singular 'grammar' and the present 'apply' matches 'is', so the sentence needs no change. 'Them' does not agree with 'grammar', and 'applied' breaks the tense.

Q.13 · Answer (C) pour

To 'pour' is to make a liquid flow out of a container. 'Pore' sounds the same but means a tiny opening, or to study closely ('pore over'), and 'power' and 'purr' do not fit.

Q.14 · Answer (B) violence

To 'deplore' is to condemn strongly, which fits the use of 'violence' against innocent people.

Q.15 · Answer (B) Eminent

As an adjective, 'august' means respected and impressive: 'eminent'. 'Imminent' means about to happen and 'illicit' unlawful.

Q.16 · Answer (B) owing to the concerned officials
The allegations are made 'against' the officials: 'investigate the allegations against the concerned officials'. 'Owing to' means 'because of' and makes no sense here.

Q.17 · Answer (B) healthy
A 'healthy' body fights off illness on its own; 'flabby' suggests poor condition, and 'happy' and 'fresh' do not fit the sense.

Q.18 · Answer (D) Command
A 'mandate' is an official order or the authority to act: 'command'. A request or a question leaves the choice to the other person.

Q.19 · Answer (D) disrespected
'Laudable' means deserving praise, so 'commendable' is a synonym. 'Disrespected', not held in esteem, is the only option opposite in sense.

Q.20 · Answer (A) generate
A country 'generates', that is produces, waste.

Q.21 · Answer (C) mean
'May' takes the bare infinitive: different words 'may mean' the same thing in different languages.

Q.22 · Answer (C) comprehend
Languages help us 'comprehend', that is understand, reality before we communicate it to others.

Q.23 · Answer (C) effectively
Languages help us express ourselves 'effectively', that is well, which gives meaning to life. 'Secretly', 'lately' and 'retrospectively' do not fit.

Q.24 · Answer (A) essential
The mother tongue is 'essential' for literary growth; the 'but' that follows turns to the need for another language to reach a wider audience.

Q.25 · Answer (A) have
'Will have to' expresses a future necessity: 'you will have to reach out'.

General Intelligence and Reasoning

Q.1 · Answer (A) ZFY
The first letter moves 2 places forward, the second 3, and the third is replaced by its opposite letter (A↔Z, B↔Y and so on): G → I, R → U, V → E. So X → Z, C → F and B → Y: ZFY.

Q.2 · Answer (A) 80
Each first number times 3, plus 5, gives its pair: 339 × 3 + 5 = 1022 and 58 × 3 + 5 = 179. So 25 × 3 + 5 = 80.

Q.4 · Answer (A) 24 : 576
The second number is the square of the first: $23^2 = 529$ and $26^2 = 676$. Likewise $24^2 = 576$; 196 is 14^2, 400 is 20^2, and 444 is not a square.

Q.5 · Answer (A) RPA
The last letter moves to the front: GRM → MGR. So PAR → RPA.

Q.7 · Answer (B) PQFN
Each letter moves 3 places forward: HOPE → KRSH and RAGF → UDJI. So MNCK → PQFN.

Q.8 · Answer (D) 70 and 48, ÷ and ×
After interchanging 70 and 48 and the signs ÷ and ×: 35 × 4 ÷ 70 + 48 − 10 = 140 ÷ 70 + 48 − 10 = 2 + 48 − 10 = 40.

Q.9 · Answer (D) 4 and 3
After interchanging 4 and 3: 9 + 6 ÷ 3 − 5 + 4 = 9 + 2 − 5 + 4 = 10.

Q.10 · Answer (A) 37
Each pair is a prime number and the next prime: 29 and 31, 19 and 23. The prime after 31 is 37.

Q.12 · Answer (B) IVGMFS
Each letter is replaced by its opposite letter (A↔Z, B↔Y and so on) and the result is reversed: PAINTS → KZRMGH → HGMRZK and ROCKY → ILXPB → BPXLI. So HUNTER → SFMGVI → IVGMFS.

Q.13 · Answer (D) Aman
Umang is below only Raman, so Raman is first, Umang second and Tanmay last. Sanam, above only one person, is sixth, which leaves third to fifth for Vikram, Pawan and Aman in that order. Aman, fifth, is between Pawan (fourth) and Sanam (sixth).

Q.14 · Answer (A) 2
G3 sits immediately left of G2, G5 two places right of G2 and G4 two places right of G5, so the row from the left is G3, G2, _, G5, _, G4. G6, second to the right of G3, takes the third seat and G1 the fifth, so two boys, G3 and G2, sit to the left of G6.

Q.15 · Answer (A) MNP14
Each letter moves 4 places forward and the number rises by 4: STV20 → WXZ24 and ABD2 → EFH6. So IJL10 → MNP14.

Q.16 · Answer (D) Only conclusion II follows
'No grey is mouse' converts to 'no mouse is grey', so II follows. The red that are mouse cannot be grey, so not all red are grey: I does not follow.

Q.17 · Answer (C) 39
The steps alternate +6 and −9: 48, 54, 45, 51, 42, 48, then 48 − 9 = 39.

Q.18 · Answer (D) None of the conclusions follow
Cars and locks are linked only through some white things, so nothing definite follows about all white things, about all locks, or that no car is a lock: none of the conclusions follows.

Q.19 · Answer (D) LNG
The first letters move 2 back (T, R, P, N, L), the second 1 back (R, Q, P, O, N) and the third 2 back (O, M, K, I, G): LNG.

Q.22 · Answer (D) Aryan
Aryan is fifth from the left. Amit, not at an end, cannot be third (Anurag, two places to his right, would take Aryan's seat) or second (with Anurag fourth, the free seats 1, 3 and 6 cannot hold Anubhav, Akshay and Ashish side by side), so Amit is fourth and Anurag sixth. Then Anubhav is third, Akshay second and Ashish first: Aryan sits between Amit and Anurag.

Q.23 · Answer (A) 71
The code is the sum of the letters' places counted from Z (A = 26, B = 25 and so on): BAG = 25 + 26 + 20 = 71 and VICE = 5 + 18 + 24 + 22 = 69. So LIKE = 15 + 18 + 16 + 22 = 71.

Q.24 · Answer (A) Pigeon
The bird that sings well is the cuckoo, and in this code 'cuckoo' is called 'pigeon'.

General Awareness

Q.1 · Answer (B) Tripura
Sangrai is danced by the Mog community of Tripura at the Sangrai festival in Chaitra, the last month of the Bengali year, to welcome the New Year.

Q.2 · Answer (D) two
India's southern neighbours across the sea are the two island countries Sri Lanka and Maldives.

Q.3 · Answer (B) 1782
Tipu Sultan succeeded his father Hyder Ali, who died in December 1782 during the Second Anglo-Mysore War.

Q.4 · Answer (D) VK Singh
'Courage and Conviction' (2013) is the autobiography of General V K Singh, Chief of the Army Staff from 2010 to 2012.

Q.5 · Answer (A) Ambubachi Festival
The Ambubachi Mela is held every June at the Kamakhya temple, marking the goddess's yearly menstruation. Mando is a Goan song form and Sunburn an electronic music festival.

Q.6 · Answer (C) Karnataka
In March 2022 six states had a Legislative Council as well as an Assembly: Andhra Pradesh, Bihar, Karnataka, Maharashtra, Telangana and Uttar Pradesh. Odisha, Gujarat and Kerala had only one House.

Q.7 · Answer (D) Madhya Pradesh
Madhya Pradesh's cabinet approved the 'Mukhyamantri Ration Aapke Dwar' scheme on 19 October 2021: vehicles take ration from the fair-price shop to the villages attached to it, for tribal families in 16 districts.

Q.8 · Answer (D) Humidity
Humidity is the amount of water vapour in the air. Precipitation is water falling as rain, snow or hail.

Q.9 · Answer (A) Article 40
Article 40 directs the State to organise village panchayats as units of self-government. Article 48 covers agriculture and animal husbandry, 43 a living wage and 39A free legal aid.

Q.10 · Answer (C) 1951
The first census after independence was taken in 1951; India's census was held every ten years from 1881 to 2011.

Q.11 · Answer (A) 168 to 212
Chapter III of Part VI, 'The State Legislature', runs from Article 168 to Article 212.

Q.12 · Answer (A) Sanskrit
Banabhatta, court poet of Harshavardhana, wrote the 'Harshacharita', a biography of the king, in Sanskrit.

Q.13 · Answer (C) Both I and II are correct.
Both are correct: turning plant and animal waste into manure is composting, and making compost with redworms is vermicomposting.

Q.14 · Answer (D) Ghatam
T H (Vikku) Vinayakram is a master of the ghatam, the clay pot of Carnatic music; he shared a Grammy for 'Planet Drum'.

Q.15 · Answer (A) Son
The Son is a tributary of the Ganga. The Kabul, Gilgit and Shyok all join the Indus.

Q.16 · Answer (B) Australia
Australia won the 2022 ICC Women's Cricket World Cup, beating England in the final at Christchurch, New Zealand, in April 2022.

Q.17 · Answer (C) Shree Narayana Guru
'One caste, one religion, one God for man' was the message of Sree Narayana Guru, the social reformer of Kerala.

Q.18 · Answer (D) Kanyakumari
NCERT describes the North-South corridor as linking Srinagar in Jammu and Kashmir with Kanyakumari in Tamil Nadu, and the East-West corridor Silchar with Porbandar.

Q.19 · Answer (A) Qutubuddin Aybak, Shamsuddin Illtutmish, Raziyaa
Qutbuddin Aibak ruled from 1206 to 1210, Iltutmish from 1211 to 1236 and his daughter Raziyya from 1236 to 1240.

Q.20 · Answer (B) Golgi apparatus
The Golgi apparatus packages materials made in the endoplasmic reticulum and dispatches them inside and outside the cell.

Q.21 · Answer (B) Ajmer
Pushkar Lake, with its many ghats and the Brahma temple, is in Ajmer district.

Q.22 · Answer (C) Khashaba Jadhav
K D (Khashaba Dadasaheb) Jadhav won bronze in bantamweight freestyle wrestling at the 1952 Helsinki Olympics, independent India's first individual Olympic medal. Rathore (2004) and Bindra (2008) won theirs later, and P T Usha never won one. (The IOC credits Norman Pritchard's two silvers of 1900 to India, but he is not among the options.)

Q.23 · Answer (D) Shah Rukh Khan
Coca-Cola India signed Shah Rukh Khan as the brand ambassador for Thums Up in February 2022, launching him in an action-themed campaign.

Q.24 · Answer (B) Kathak
Pandit Birju Maharaj (1938-2022) of the Lucknow gharana was a leading Kathak dancer; he received the Padma Vibhushan in 1986.

Q.25 · Answer (B) Hydrogen
H is the symbol of hydrogen, element 1. Helium is He, holmium Ho and mercury Hg.

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